

CHAPTER 1

Meet Claude — and Make It Yours

Getting started with Claude — the essentials

What	How
Sign up	Go to claude.ai and create a free account
Install the desktop app	claude.ai/download — Windows or Mac
Start a conversation	Type in the text box at the bottom and hit Enter
Give good context	Tell Claude who, what, why, and any constraints — like you'd brief a colleague
Iterate	Tell Claude what to fix: "shorter," "more formal," "I forgot to mention..."
Start a new conversation	Click the + icon for a fresh thread when you switch topics

Your First Prompt Template

I need to [what you're trying to accomplish]. The context is [relevant background]. The audience is [who will see this]. I want it to be [tone/style]. Can you help?

Things to Try in Your First Week

- 1. Write an email you've been putting off
- 2. Get help planning something — an event, a project, a trip
- 3. Ask Claude to explain something confusing in plain English
- 4. Brainstorm ideas for something you care about
- 5. Organize your thoughts on a decision you're facing

This reference card is a companion to Chapter 1 of Creating with Claude by Chris Thatcher. More reader resources at [marquepublishing.com/reader](#).